to some extent. The Moslems in upper India were culturally and economically far superior to their co-religionists of Bengal, but even they kept aloof from western education.

The Hindus took to this education more easily and were more influenced by western ideas. The subordinate Government services and the professions had far more Hindus than Moslems. Onl in the Punjab this difference was less marked.

The Revolt of 1857-58 flared up and was crushed, but Bengal was hardly touched by it. Throughout the nineteenth century the new English-educated class, mainly Hindu, looked up with admiration towards England and hoped to advance with her help and in co-operation with her. There was a cultural renais-sance and a remarkable growth of the Bengali language, and the leaders of Bengal stood out as the leaders of political India. Some glimpse of that faith in England which filled the mind of Bengal in those days, as well as of the revolt against old-established social codes, may be had from that moving message of Rabindranath Tagore, which he gave on his eightieth birth-day (May, 1941), a few months before his death. 'As I look back,' he says, 'on the vast stretch of years that lie behind me and see in clear perspective